

Ghana BRS — Matching Approach for Reconciliation

Position note on match-by-counting vs corroborated matching in the SaaS product

Hello Sir,

Thank you for your note on **match by counting** for bank reconciliation. We reviewed it carefully against the live Ghana BRS product. Your thinking on **how the BRS lists should be organised** is valuable, and we want to align the system with that structure — while keeping the clearing rules that are safe and efficient for a multi-user SaaS platform (not only a personal workbook).

1. What we agree with (and will align to)

Your process is right about **structure**:

- Treat **receipts and payments separately** (and bank credits versus debits the same way).
- Use amounts to see what is **only in the cash book, only on the bank**, and what appears on **both sides**.
- When amounts appear on both sides and the **batch totals cancel**, that belongs on a **separate matched schedule**.
- When they **do not cancel**, those residuals belong in the **BRS detail lists**.

That is how a good bank reconciliation *thinks*. We will bring those **counting lists and schedules into the product** as a clear working view and supporting report — so you get the picture you described.

2. What we will not do as the only clearing rule — and why

You indicated that the match criterion should use **only the amount**, and not date, description, or cheque number.

For a **personal spreadsheet or one-client desktop file**, amount-only counting can feel efficient: one expert knows the books, and wrong matches are often caught by eye.

For a **SaaS BRS used by many firms, many banks, and many users**, making amount-only the engine that *decides* a match does **not** improve real efficiency. It often creates more rework later. The reasons are:

Same amount is not the same transaction.

GHS 5,000.00 (or any round figure) can appear many times for different payees, different cheques, or different days. Counting “five on the cash book and five on the bank” and treating them as cleared can hide real outstanding items. That looks fast on day one and fails on review, audit, or client query.

Efficiency means correct clear with less redo — not the fewest clicks before the first list.

If the system silently clears by amount count, users later spend time unpicking wrong matches, rebuilding the BRS, and explaining differences. That is slower end-to-end than suggesting pairs with amount plus date / cheque / reference / narration, then confirming.

Ghana bank statements carry useful signals.

Cheque numbers, INW CLG, EBOX, transfers, payee text, and value dates are how banks describe movements. Ignoring them throws away the information that makes matching safe and fast across Ecobank, SCB, GCB, NIB, Prudential, Absa, Bank of Africa, and others. The product already uses those patterns so it works across banks — not only one style of file.

SaaS must be defensible for many users, not only the expert who designed the method.

On a personal workbook, you are the control. In SaaS, juniors, multiple clients, and future auditors use the same rules. The product must default to rules that stay safe when the expert is not in the room. Amount-only auto-clear is a poor default for that.

We already closed known false-positive gaps for go-live.

The live matcher deliberately does not treat amount alone as enough to suggest or auto-clear. That was intentional best practice for a production BRS, not an oversight. Switching the core engine to amount-only would weaken what we have already hardened for live use.

3. Best-practice model for this SaaS (so both methods win)

The right design for a commercial reconciliation product is:

Role	Method
Decide what matched (system of record)	Pair / group match with amount plus corroboration (date, cheque/reference, narration, bank patterns). User (or safe gated auto-match) confirms.
See the picture your way	Match-by-counting diagnostic: counts per amount by side; only cash book / only bank / both-open / both-cancel schedules.
BRS details	Built from what did not clear after proper matching — the same list shape you care about, with safer clears.

In short: **counting guides and reports; corroborated matching clears**. That is standard practice for modern reconciliation products: diagnostics for speed of insight, controlled matching for accuracy and audit.

4. What this means in practice

- You do **not** lose your counting logic — we are **adding** it as the lists and schedules you asked for.
- You do **not** need to abandon the current reconcile flow — it is the safe clear path for a multi-client SaaS.
- When both are used together, you get a fast “where are the imbalances?” view from counting, and trustworthy “these lines are matched” decisions from the live engine.

If your note was meant mainly as a **reporting layout** (the four lists plus a separate cancel report), we are fully aligned. If it was meant as the **only automatic match rule**, that is the part that does not enhance efficiency or quality for SaaS — and that is why we keep corroboration on clears.

We are happy to walk through one specimen together (cash book + bank statement) showing: (1) the count schedule in your structure, and (2) how the current matcher clears the same period without amount-only false clears.

Thank you again. Your structure for the BRS lists is valuable; we are folding it into the right layer of the product so the system remains both practical for you and sound for SaaS use.

Kind regards,

KQ Soft Solutions — Ghana BRS Product Team